



Pack 03

# Legal & admin.

Not about winning. About knowing where things stand.

In this pack

- |    |                        |         |
|----|------------------------|---------|
| 08 | Admin checklist        | 5 pages |
| 09 | Lawyer & mediator prep | 3 pages |
| 10 | Accounts tracker       | 1 page  |
| 11 | Household admin map    | 1 page  |
| 12 | Separation timeline    | 1 page  |

Weekly reset → Tool 13, in Pack 04.

Where it lives in the app

**Admin** holds documents, accounts and appointment prep.

**Records** keeps the dated log and shared costs.

**Money** has the child support estimator.

Practical organisation only. Not legal advice.

# Know where the paper lives.

The separation admin load in five lists, grouped by where they live in your life. You don't need to finish any of them this week. Tick what's already done, cross out what doesn't apply. First, the paper: lawyers, the ATO, banks, schools and insurers will ask for these again and again.

First month? Start with Tool 01.

Today

This week

By day 30

Ongoing

## 01 Identity, legal & documents

Find it, photograph it, file it

### Identity

This week

- ☐ Passport, yours
- ☐ Passports, children's
- ☐ Birth certificate, yours
- ☐ Birth certificates, children's
- ☐ Medicare card
- ☐ Tax file number
- ☐ Driver licence
- ☐ Marriage certificate, if married
- ☐ Anything showing a de facto relationship, if relevant (joint lease, joint accounts)

### Legal

By day 30

- ☐ Separation date notes
- ☐ Existing agreements
- ☐ Consent orders
- ☐ Court documents
- ☐ Mediation records
- ☐ Legal correspondence
- ☐ Property settlement documents

### Children

This week

- ☐ Children's Medicare details
- ☐ Immunisation records
- ☐ School reports
- ☐ School login details
- ☐ Childcare agreements
- ☐ Where the parenting plan or orders are kept
- ☐ Children's travel documents

### Financial

This week

- ☐ Most recent tax return
- ☐ Super statements
- ☐ Insurance policies
- ☐ Bank statements
- ☐ Mortgage statements
- ☐ Loan documents

### Estate & authority

By day 30

- ☐ Will
- ☐ Power of attorney
- ☐ Super beneficiary nomination
- ☐ Life insurance beneficiary details

#### If you only do one thing

Take a phone photo of every document you find and drop them into a single private folder. Searchable beats neat.

# Untangle the shared accounts.

Most of this list is one or two phone calls. Boring on the day, worth thousands by year two. Review and document first. Get advice before closing or changing shared facilities.

## 02 Bank, super & insurance

[In the app: Money →](#)

- |                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                   |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Review access to joint accounts. Get advice before closing, withdrawing from or changing shared facilities. <b>Today</b> | <input type="checkbox"/> Open a bank account solely in your name. <b>This week</b>                                |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Download recent bank, credit card and loan statements before access changes. <b>This week</b>                            | <input type="checkbox"/> Move salary payments and direct debits to your new account. <b>This week</b>             |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Check joint credit cards, redraw facilities and offset accounts. <b>This week</b>                                        | <input type="checkbox"/> Check PayPal, Apple Pay, Google Pay, buy now pay later and saved cards. <b>This week</b> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Check whether any insurance premiums come out of a joint account. <b>This week</b>                                       | <input type="checkbox"/> Check for accounts still jointly held that shouldn't be. <b>By day 30</b>                |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Give your super fund your new address. <b>By day 30</b>                                                                  | <input type="checkbox"/> Review your super beneficiary nomination, and update it if needed. <b>By day 30</b>      |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Check whether life insurance is through super or separate. <b>By day 30</b>                                              | <input type="checkbox"/> Review the nominated beneficiaries on life insurance. <b>By day 30</b>                   |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Private health: are you still on a joint or family policy? <b>By day 30</b>                                              | <input type="checkbox"/> Move to singles or single-parent cover if needed. <b>By day 30</b>                       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Confirm whose policy the children are covered under. <b>By day 30</b>                                                    | <input type="checkbox"/> Car insurance: is the policy still in the right name? <b>By day 30</b>                   |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Set up or review income protection insurance, if relevant. <b>Ongoing</b>                                                |                                                                                                                   |

**Which shared account or policy are you least sure about?**

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# Sort the official paper trail.

Government, tax and payment systems keep running on old information long after life has changed. This list catches the slow-burn admin before it becomes a bigger problem.

## 03 Government, tax & payments

[In the app: Admin →](#)

- |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                              |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Let Services Australia know if your income, living situation or care arrangements have changed. <b>This week</b>                                                                        | <input type="checkbox"/> Contact Services Australia about child support, if relevant. <b>This week</b>       |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Decide how child support will be paid: privately between you, or collected through Services Australia. <b>By day 30</b><br><a href="#">In the app: Money, child support estimator →</a> | <input type="checkbox"/> Check Family Tax Benefit eligibility if you care for children. <b>By day 30</b>     |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Update Child Care Subsidy details, if relevant. <b>By day 30</b>                                                                                                                        | <input type="checkbox"/> Update Medicare household details. <b>By day 30</b>                                 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Give the ATO your new address. <b>By day 30</b>                                                                                                                                         | <input type="checkbox"/> Tell your accountant or tax agent your circumstances have changed. <b>By day 30</b> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Lodge any overdue tax returns. <b>By day 30</b>                                                                                                                                         | <input type="checkbox"/> Update your electoral roll address. <b>By day 30</b>                                |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Update your driver licence address. <b>By day 30</b>                                                                                                                                    | <input type="checkbox"/> Update your vehicle registration address. <b>By day 30</b>                          |
| <input type="checkbox"/> When you next lodge, update your relationship status. It can change your Medicare levy and offsets. <b>Ongoing</b>                                                                      | <input type="checkbox"/> Check your HELP (study loan) balance and repayments. <b>Ongoing</b>                 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Keep records of agreed child-related expenses. <b>Ongoing</b> <a href="#">In the app: Records →</a>                                                                                     |                                                                                                              |

**What official record is most likely to still have old information attached to it?**

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# Make the home systems visible.

Home admin is part legal, part practical, part “where did that bill go?” This list separates the house, the utilities and the shared things that can quietly become expensive.

04

## Home, property & utilities

In the app: [Admin](#) →

- ☐ If renting, make sure the lease is in the correct name and signed. This week

☐ Update security codes, keys and garage remotes, if appropriate. This week

☐ Set up electricity in the correct name. By day 30

☐ Set up internet in the correct name. By day 30

☐ Update home and contents insurance for your current home. By day 30

☐ Locate property title, purchase documents and rates notices. By day 30

☐ Cancel, split or update shared subscriptions and deliveries. By day 30 [In the app: Money](#) →

☐ Get a property valuation, if needed. Ongoing

☐ List shared household items still to be divided. Ongoing
- ☐ Update lease, mortgage or property correspondence address. This week

☐ Take photos of household contents and shared valuables. This week

☐ Set up gas in the correct name, if relevant. By day 30

☐ Update water and council correspondence, if relevant. By day 30

☐ Review mortgage statements and home loan access. By day 30

☐ Update the mailing address for important services. By day 30

☐ Review vehicle ownership, registration, finance and insurance. By day 30

☐ Record renovation, repair and major purchase records. Ongoing

☐ Record storage unit details, if relevant. Ongoing

Which home system would cause the most trouble if it failed this month?

# Keep the kids' week running.

Fewer missed messages, fewer forgotten forms and fewer small shocks in the middle of a school week. Details for each child go on Tool 07, the kids' info sheet.

## 05 Kids, school & medical

[In the app: Week →](#)

- |                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                 |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Update school enrolment records with current addresses and contacts. <b>This week</b>                                           | <input type="checkbox"/> Confirm emergency contacts. <b>This week</b>                                           |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Confirm pickup and drop-off permissions. <b>This week</b>                                                                       | <input type="checkbox"/> Confirm both parents are listed on school records, where appropriate. <b>By day 30</b> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Confirm both parents get school app and email updates, where appropriate. <b>By day 30</b>                                      | <input type="checkbox"/> Record school login details. <b>By day 30</b>                                          |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Add school events, pupil-free days and term dates to your calendar. <b>By day 30</b> <a href="#">In the app: Week →</a>         | <input type="checkbox"/> Record allergies, medications and regular health needs. <b>By day 30</b>               |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Record dental, orthodontic and specialist details. <b>By day 30</b>                                                             | <input type="checkbox"/> Confirm Medicare access for the children. <b>By day 30</b>                             |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Confirm private health cover for the children. <b>By day 30</b>                                                                 | <input type="checkbox"/> Register the children with a GP close to your home, if needed. <b>By day 30</b>        |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Record school fees, uniforms, devices and upcoming costs. <b>Ongoing</b> <a href="#">In the app: Money →</a>                    | <input type="checkbox"/> Record extracurricular schedules, contacts and fees. <b>Ongoing</b>                    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Agree how uniforms, devices, sport, tutoring and school costs are handled. <b>Ongoing</b> <a href="#">In the app: Records →</a> | <input type="checkbox"/> Decide how out-of-pocket medical and dental costs are shared. <b>Ongoing</b>           |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Plan ahead for school holidays. <b>Ongoing</b> <a href="#">In the app: Week →</a>                                               |                                                                                                                 |

**What's the one repeated kid-admin task that needs a clearer system?**

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# Calmer questions, clearer answers.

Preparation for any meeting that costs by the hour: a first legal appointment, mediation, a property or parenting plan discussion. Tick the questions that match where you are, add your own, cross out the rest. Write the answers on page 03.

## 01 Parenting

- ☐ 01 What arrangements tend to work for kids the ages of ours?
- ☐ 02 What factors matter most legally regarding the children?
- ☐ 03 How are school schedules usually handled?
- ☐ 04 What documentation is useful to keep?
- ☐ 05 What should we avoid doing right now?
- ☐ 06 How is communication usually managed between separated parents?
- ☐ 07 What does a workable interim arrangement look like before anything is final?
- ☐ 08 How should we handle holidays, birthdays, school events and changeovers?
- ☐ 09 What should I do if we disagree about a child-related decision?

## 02 Financial & property

- ☐ 01 What financial information will likely be needed?
- ☐ 02 How are shared assets usually assessed?
- ☐ 03 What happens with superannuation?
- ☐ 04 What are the likely next steps from here?
- ☐ 05 What timelines are realistic?
- ☐ 06 What costs should I prepare for?
- ☐ 07 What financial mistakes should I avoid right now?
- ☐ 08 What should I avoid changing, selling, closing or transferring before getting advice?
- ☐ 09 How should shared expenses be handled while things are unresolved?
- ☐ 10 What are the main options if one of us wants to keep the home?

# Ask what changes your next step.

Cost, Family Dispute Resolution and time limits change what you do next more than anything else. People often wish they'd asked sooner.

## 03 Questions to ask first

- ☐ How do you charge, and what usually costs the most?
- ☐ Do we need to try Family Dispute Resolution first, and where would we go?
- ☐ Are there time limits I need to know about?
- ☐ Am I eligible for Legal Aid or low-cost help?
- ☐ What should I do if there are safety concerns?
- ☐ What should I be keeping a record of, and how?

## 04 Mediation preparation

Before the session

- ☐ 01 What should I prepare before mediation?
- ☐ 02 What outcomes are realistic for us?
- ☐ 03 What documents should I bring?
- ☐ 04 What usually slows agreements down?
- ☐ 05 What helps conversations stay productive?

## 05 Personal clarity

For you, not the meeting

Write the version that's true for you, not the version that sounds reasonable.

**What outcome matters most right now?**

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**What feels most uncertain?**

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**What would help me feel calmer after this appointment?**

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# Write it down before you leave.

You're paying for the answers. Bring the file, then write down what they said while it's still clear. Print one of these per meeting.

## Bring with you

☐ Tool 02 Financial snapshot☐ Your document list, Tool 08 page 01☐ An export of your log [In the app: Records →](#)☐ Tool 12 Separation timeline☐ These questions, with your ticks

## 06 Notes from the meeting

Date

Who

### What they said

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### What I do next

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This meeting cost

\$

Cost so far

\$

# Hidden admin becomes visible.

Don't write passwords here.

One sheet showing where the household logs in, whose name each account is in, and who can still get into it. Fewer missed payments and less access confusion at the worst possible time.

| Account                      | Login email | In whose name | Can my ex access it?                                  | 2FA on?                  |
|------------------------------|-------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Banking                      |             |               | <input type="checkbox"/> Y <input type="checkbox"/> N | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Super                        |             |               | <input type="checkbox"/> Y <input type="checkbox"/> N | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| myGov, tax & Centrelink      |             |               | <input type="checkbox"/> Y <input type="checkbox"/> N | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Child support                |             |               | <input type="checkbox"/> Y <input type="checkbox"/> N | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Mortgage                     |             |               | <input type="checkbox"/> Y <input type="checkbox"/> N | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Insurance                    |             |               | <input type="checkbox"/> Y <input type="checkbox"/> N | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Utilities                    |             |               | <input type="checkbox"/> Y <input type="checkbox"/> N | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Phone provider               |             |               | <input type="checkbox"/> Y <input type="checkbox"/> N | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Internet                     |             |               | <input type="checkbox"/> Y <input type="checkbox"/> N | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Email                        |             |               | <input type="checkbox"/> Y <input type="checkbox"/> N | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Cloud storage & photos       |             |               | <input type="checkbox"/> Y <input type="checkbox"/> N | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Medical                      |             |               | <input type="checkbox"/> Y <input type="checkbox"/> N | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| School portals               |             |               | <input type="checkbox"/> Y <input type="checkbox"/> N | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Streaming services           |             |               | <input type="checkbox"/> Y <input type="checkbox"/> N | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Shopping & buy now pay later |             |               | <input type="checkbox"/> Y <input type="checkbox"/> N | <input type="checkbox"/> |

Security

The app keeps your data on this device. Paper doesn't. Keep these sheets somewhere private, and don't leave printed copies in shared spaces. Use a password manager for the passwords themselves. This page is the map, not the vault.

# Make the invisible work visible.

Households run on quiet, repeating jobs that one person usually owns. List them, see where they land now, and tick the ones that need a plan.

01

Recurring jobs

Map, don't litigate

| Task                 | Previously done by | Now done by | How often | Needs a plan             |
|----------------------|--------------------|-------------|-----------|--------------------------|
| Bills                |                    |             |           | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| School admin         |                    |             |           | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| School forms         |                    |             |           | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Groceries            |                    |             |           | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Insurance            |                    |             |           | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Tax                  |                    |             |           | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Car registration     |                    |             |           | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Vehicle maintenance  |                    |             |           | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Home maintenance     |                    |             |           | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Medical appointments |                    |             |           | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Kids activities      |                    |             |           | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Birthdays & gifts    |                    |             |           | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Subscriptions        |                    |             |           | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Pets                 |                    |             |           | <input type="checkbox"/> |

Which household systems need rebuilding first?

# Dates blur under stress.

Write them down while you remember them. This isn't a legal statement. It's a private one-page summary you can come back to when something matters.

In the app: [Records](#) → [keep the running log there](#). This page is the one-page summary.

01

## Important dates

As they come back to you

| Date | Event or note |
|------|---------------|
|      |               |
|      |               |
|      |               |
|      |               |
|      |               |
|      |               |
|      |               |

| Date | Event or note |
|------|---------------|
|      |               |
|      |               |
|      |               |
|      |               |
|      |               |
|      |               |
|      |               |

02

## Key changes

Approximate is fine

| Change                                   | Approximate timing |
|------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| Separated under one roof (if it applies) |                    |
| Financial separation                     |                    |
| Living arrangements changed              |                    |
| Parenting changes                        |                    |
| Legal appointments started               |                    |

### Why your separation date matters.

In Australia you can apply for divorce once you've been separated for 12 months. Property claims have time limits: 12 months after a divorce is final, or 2 years after a de facto relationship ends. Check your dates with a lawyer.

### Paper can't fix a separation.

#### It can stop it surprising you.

Most admin stress is not knowing: where the document is, which account is still joint, when the date was. Now you know where to look.